

Social Media Audit

PlayStation / @PlayStation

Audit Date: June 2026 | Platforms: Instagram, TikTok, Twitter/X, YouTube | Author: Justin Narciso

Overview

PlayStation is one of the most recognized gaming brands in the world, with tens of millions of followers across every major social platform. They have consistent brand voice, a strong content library, and a community that generates organic attention most brands pay significant money to replicate.

This audit is not about what they are doing wrong. It is about where the engagement data points and where effort could be better spent. I reviewed their presence on Instagram, TikTok, Twitter/X, and YouTube, compared their approach to Xbox, and identified three gaps worth addressing.

At a Glance

What I measured	What I found
Instagram followers	28.9 million
Twitter/X followers	25.5 million
Facebook followers	38 million
Monthly organic website visitors	~46.3 million
TikTok engagement rate (industry avg, 2025)	3.70% -- 7x higher than Instagram
Instagram engagement rate (industry avg, 2025)	0.48%
Facebook engagement rate (industry avg, 2025)	0.15% -- very low

What I measured	What I found
Instagram feed post reach for large accounts	18 to 30% of followers -- down from 40 to 50%
Reels vs. static post engagement	Reels outperform static by 44%
PlayStation TikTok consistency	Inconsistent -- underdeveloped

What Works

1. Different content for different platforms

PlayStation is not cross-posting the same asset everywhere. Twitter/X gets news and real-time reactions. Instagram gets polished visuals and game art. YouTube gets trailers and developer interviews. A lot of brands post the same thing on every platform and wonder why engagement is low. PlayStation does not do that, and it shows in how the audience responds on each channel.

2. The community does a lot of the work for them

Streamers, fan accounts, and gaming creators cover every PlayStation release without any coordination from the brand. That kind of organic attention is hard to buy. PlayStation benefits from it consistently, which also means their paid influencer spend can stay lower than competitors while still maintaining visibility across the internet.

3. The brand voice actually sounds human

Across platforms, PlayStation sounds like it is run by people who play games. The Twitter/X account in particular reads conversationally and engages with the community rather than just broadcasting announcements. For a brand this large, that tone is not easy to maintain and they do it consistently.

4. Multi-platform campaign execution

PlayStation has run coordinated campaigns across TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube that generate real numbers. A Need for Speed campaign involving creator partnerships across all three platforms pulled over 28 million impressions. That kind of cross-platform coordination is hard to execute well and they have done it more than once.

What I Found

1. TikTok is not being used seriously

TikTok's average brand engagement rate hit 3.70% in 2025 -- up 49% from the year before and more than seven times Instagram's 0.48%. Brands that post fewer than six times per week on TikTok see 93% higher engagement than those that post more, meaning the platform rewards quality over volume. PlayStation's TikTok presence is inconsistent. For a brand trying to reach 16 to 24 year olds -- 79% of whom are on TikTok -- this is the biggest gap in the whole audit.

2. Instagram feed posts are not reaching anyone

Instagram shifted its algorithm toward watch time in 2026. Feed post reach for large accounts dropped to 18 to 30% of followers, down from 40 to 50% in 2024. Reels outperform static posts by 44% in engagement. If PlayStation's primary Instagram format is still polished game art posted as static images, they are losing reach on nearly every post. The same content produced as a Reel performs significantly better with no additional production cost.

3. Facebook is getting too much attention

PlayStation's largest follower count is on Facebook at 38 million. But the average brand engagement rate on Facebook in 2025 was 0.15% -- about 25 times lower than TikTok. Brands across the industry cut their Facebook posting frequency by 48% last year because the return stopped justifying the effort. The question is not whether PlayStation should have a Facebook presence. It is whether the production time going into it should shift somewhere else.

PlayStation vs. Xbox

Platform	PlayStation	Xbox	Edge
Instagram	28.9M followers, strong visual library	More aggressive Reels cadence	Xbox
TikTok	Inconsistent, underdeveloped	More consistent, more native-feeling content	Xbox
Twitter / X	25.5M, conversational, gamer-native tone	Strong but PlayStation's voice is sharper	PlayStation
YouTube	Dominant -- trailers, dev content, events	Strong Game Pass content, less cinematic	PlayStation

Platform	PlayStation	Xbox	Edge
UGC	Organic but not systematically amplified	More structured UGC programs	Xbox

What I Would Fix

Go Reels-first on Instagram

The primary Instagram format should shift from static game art to short-form Reels. This does not mean scrapping the visual identity -- it means animating it. Gameplay clips, vertical cuts of cinematic trailers, behind-the-scenes content, and reaction-style posts all fit the format and perform better with the algorithm. Static posts can still fill the feed but they should not carry the reach strategy. Target four to five Reels per week.

Treat TikTok as a primary channel

TikTok is where PlayStation's core audience spends most of their time -- 3.5 hours per day on average for 16 to 24 year olds. The content there should be built natively: trending audio, duets with gaming creators, raw gameplay moments. Not repurposed trailer cuts. Posting five to six times a week with content that feels native to TikTok will outperform the current inconsistent approach every time.

Build a structured UGC program

PlayStation's community creates more content than almost any gaming brand's audience on the internet. There is no structured way to surface and amplify it. A weekly community spotlight, a dedicated hashtag campaign, or a creator tier below the top influencer deals would turn passive community energy into something the brand can actually drive and measure. Xbox does this more deliberately and it shows in how their community shows up around releases.

Where the time and money comes from

None of this requires new budget. Reducing Facebook content production by 40 to 50% and redirecting that time toward TikTok-native content and Reels covers most of what is needed. The UGC program is low-cost by design. The allocation shift is the whole strategy.

4-Week Content Calendar

A sample calendar showing what the revised strategy looks like in practice. Built around a hypothetical new title release in Week 3.

WEEK 1 -- BRAND BUILDING

Platform	Content	Format	Posts/ week
Instagram	Game art carousel + 3 Reels (community moments, gameplay clip, behind-the-scenes)	Reels + Carousel	4x
TikTok	Trending audio + gameplay, community duet, native trend participation	Native video	5x
Twitter/X	Community polls, gaming news commentary, UGC retweets	Text + image	Daily
YouTube	Developer spotlight -- 8 to 12 min behind-the-scenes on upcoming title	Long-form	1x

WEEK 2 -- HYPE BUILDING

Platform	Content	Format	Posts/ week
Instagram	Teaser Reels for upcoming title, countdown story series, influencer takeover	Reels + Stories	5x
TikTok	Teaser clips, creator reactions to announcement, challenge launch	Native video	5x
Twitter/X	Countdown thread, fan theory engagement, hints dropped in replies	Thread + replies	Daily
YouTube	Official trailer with optimized thumbnail, Shorts cut for algorithm	Trailer + Shorts	2x

WEEK 3 -- LAUNCH WEEK

Platform	Content	Format	Posts/ week
Instagram	Launch day Reel, gameplay highlight clips, community reaction reposts	Reels	6x

Platform	Content	Format	Posts/ week
TikTok	Launch day hype, creator gameplay clips, UGC aggregation, duet responses	Native video	6x
Twitter/X	Live launch coverage, real-time community engagement, sales milestone posts	Live text	High-freq
YouTube	Launch livestream, full gameplay walkthrough, review roundup	Live + VOD	3x

WEEK 4 -- COMMUNITY AND RETENTION

Platform	Content	Format	Posts/ week
Instagram	Community spotlight (UGC), tips and tricks Reels, first-week moments compilation	Reels + UGC	4x
TikTok	Player clips, hidden secrets content, ongoing challenge amplification	Native video	5x
Twitter/X	Community Q&A, weekly UGC spotlight, patch notes announcements	Text + media	Daily
YouTube	Player stories / community video, first patch breakdown	Long-form	1 to 2x

Summary

PlayStation's brand, community, and content library are real assets. The opportunity is in pointing them at the right platforms and formats for where audiences actually spend time in 2026. Three changes cover most of it: go Reels-first on Instagram, treat TikTok as a primary channel with native content, and build a structured program to amplify the UGC the community is already creating. None of it requires new budget -- just a reallocation away from Facebook, where the data no longer supports the effort.

The biggest single change is TikTok. Engagement rates there are seven times higher than Instagram right now, and PlayStation's core demographic spends more daily time on TikTok than any other platform. That is where the attention is.

